

THE INTIMIDATED

THE CURRENT PRESIDENT OF INDIA AND AS MANY AS FOUR CABINET MINISTERS WERE REJECTED BY THE UPA AND THE LEFT, AS THEY SEARCHED FOR THE PERFECT PLIABLE CANDIDATE FOR RAISINA HILL

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A.P.J. ABDUL KALAM

The people's President would have won hands down in any public poll. But this is politics. First he said he would contest as the "consensus candidate" of the Third Front but only if he was assured of "certainty of contest". Later he perished the thought, hurt by the high-velocity sniper attack of the UPA. Here is a sampling of the voices that hurt the sensitive President.

The game is over for him. He will neither be in the team, nor in the field, or at the crease.

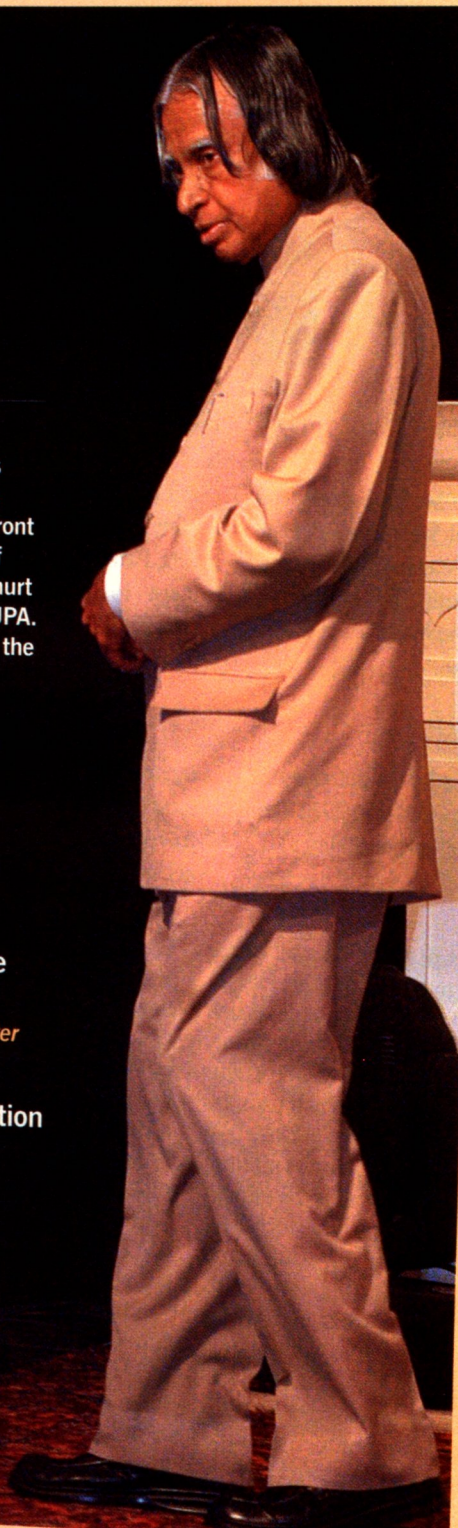
SHARAD PAWAR, *Agriculture Minister*

The word certainty means ensure the numbers. This is unfortunate. Nobody should denigrate the office of the President.

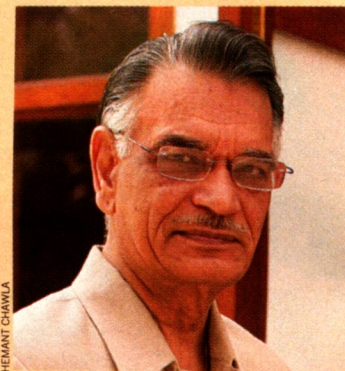
PRIYA RANJAN DASMUNSHI, *I&B Minister*

Kalam should resign gracefully as it is too late for any reconsideration of the issue.

LALU PRASAD YADAV, *Railways Minister*



SUMEEET INDER SINGH



HEMANT CHAWLA

SHIVRAJ PATIL

Even as he began accepting the first rush of congratulations, he found himself out of the race. Thanks to the Left's objection to his devoted genuflection of the Sathya Sai Baba of Puttaparthi and his bias towards the BJP as Lok Sabha Speaker. He is hurt that his party didn't think he was worth fighting for.



SIPRA DAS

ARJUN SINGH

This was literally his moment. He had carved a quota for himself nursing the Left and the OBC constituency. DMK Chief Karunanidhi forced his name into the hat. The Left agreed. It wasn't his fitness to take the 21-gun salute that was in question, but his talent to hijack the agenda that did him in.